

From Tribal Knowledge to Code

Custom Skills for GitHub Copilot Modernization

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Team knowledge

Actionable skill

Reviewable change

Turn a repeated explanation into a reusable workflow

It compiles. Is it right for us?

**Technical
correctness**

**Business
correctness**

**Organizational
fit**

33.35 x 3 | Partner total: 102.04

A successful build answers only one question

The rules that never made it into the prompt

R1 Pricing exception

R2 JSON contract

R3 Audit convention

R4 Safe diagnostics

Existing source contains clues; the skill captures intent

Put the right knowledge in the right place

Prompt
Immediate task

Instructions
Project conventions

Skill
Specialized workflow

Tests and CI
Executable checks

Assess > Plan > Change > Review

First pass: modernize the technology

Newtonsoft.Json

System.Text.Json

Baseline capture: not-run

Fallback: explicitly labeled reference walkthrough

Same behavior. Inspect the actual diff

Turn one rule into actionable guidance

Keep the optional field

"review_note": null

```
DefaultIgnoreCondition =  
JsonIgnoreCondition.Never
```

When it applies + what to preserve + example + evidence

A skill is more than a long prompt

SKILL.md

Supporting references

Workflow + review criteria

name:
northwind-modernization

Task-specific activation
Self-contained resources

Guidance, not guaranteed enforcement

Same task. Explicit organizational context

Same legacy input

Skill-guided request

Guided capture: not-run

Fallback: explicitly labeled reference walkthrough

Matching source hashes. Additional skill context

What we will compare

Migration + build

Not-run

Pricing + wire contract

Not-run

Audit + diagnostics

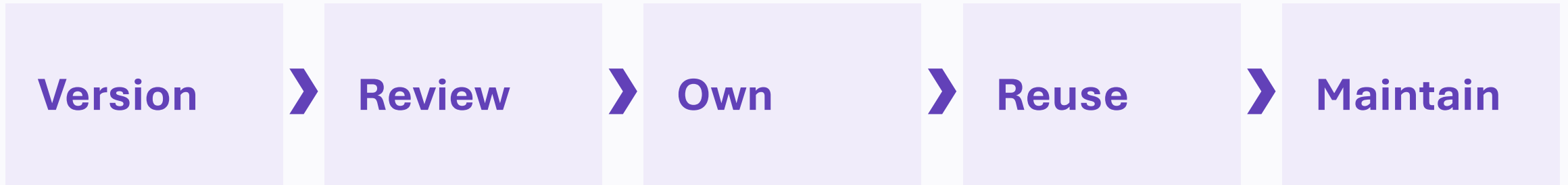
Not-run

Diff scope + review

Not-run

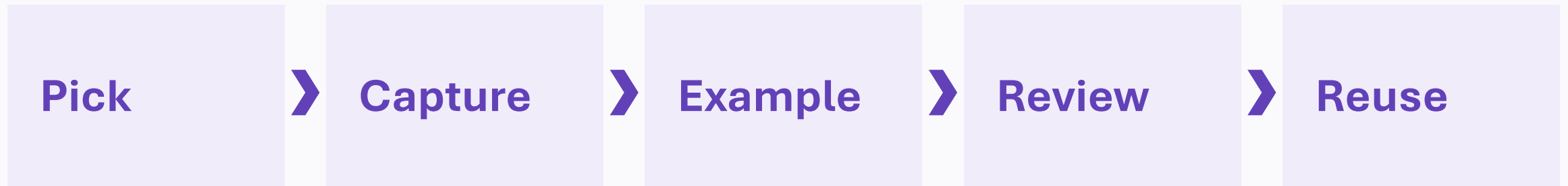
No captured runs. No declared winner

From one developer to team practice



Skills guide. Tests check. People decide

Your first skill starts with one repeated explanation



Pick one task. Capture one rule. Review the result

Try the workflow

Sample repository link pending

Official agent skills docs

Official upgrade docs

Q&A

Make knowledge explicit. Check behavior. Reuse what works